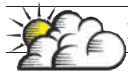


The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

RE V1 V2 V3 V4



Partly sunny 73/57 • Tomorrow: Rain, windy 76/54 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 18, 2025 • \$4

GOP seeks to rebrand ‘No Kings’ marches

Anti-authoritarian protests express hatred of U.S., Republicans say

BY AMY B WANG
AND KATIE TARRANT

Ahead of thousands of anti-authoritarian “No Kings” protests planned for Saturday across the United States, Republicans are trying to brand the demonstrations as “hate America” rallies, ramping up their rhetoric about the millions of people expected to peacefully protest President Donald Trump and his administration’s policies as they did in June.

For more than a week, House Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana) and other GOP leaders have cast the “No Kings” rallies as un-American, using increasingly hyperbolic language. Johnson and other members of House GOP leadership, including Majority Leader Steve Scalise (Louisiana), Majority Whip Tom Emmer (Minnesota), and Republican Conference Chair Lisa C. McClain (Michigan), have all described the protests as events for people who “hate” the country, with Johnson and Emmer going as far as to suggest the protests are meant to appease a “terrorist wing” of the Democratic Party.

“We call it the ‘hate America’ rally that will happen Saturday. Let’s see who shows up for that,” Johnson said Wednesday at a news conference with other House GOP leaders. “I bet you you’ll see Hamas supporters, I bet you’ll see antifa types, I bet you’ll see the Marxists on full display, the people who don’t want to stand and defend the foundational truths of this republic.”

Democrats and organizers of the more than 2,600 events scheduled for Saturday have said they’re outraged by this characterization, defending the protests as peaceful and pointing out there were relatively few disruptions at the rallies in June. They also warned of attempts to stifle

SEE MARCH ON A5

Around D.C.: 100,000 protesters expected today near Capitol. **B15**



President Donald Trump and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky meet Friday at the White House. Zelensky came seeking U.S. missiles that could strike Moscow. Trump initially sounded receptive, but his tone changed after speaking with the Russian president.

DEMETRIUS FREEMAN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Free but traumatized, Israeli hostages begin their recovery

Readjustment includes reunions, hospital care after 2 years in captivity

BY SHIRA RUBIN
AND LIOR SOROKA

TEL AVIV — Every night, over two anguished years, Omri Miran’s wife and two young girls gazed at the moon as the children said good night to their father, a 48-year-old Israeli hostage held by Hamas in Gaza.

Since the Hamas assault on southern Israel in October 2023, Miran had been shackled in a cage, shuffled between subterranean tunnels and aboveground buildings, and — although sporadically allowed to listen to Arab media — repeatedly denied infor-

mation about the fate of his family. Only after about five months of captivity was he transferred to a “relatively normal guard who told him that his family is alive,” said Boaz Miran, Omri’s brother, speaking by phone from Ichilov Hospital in Tel Aviv, where he and the family have camped out since Omri’s release on Monday.

“Now, the goal is to strengthen his connection again with his girls,” Boaz said. He added that Miran’s youngest daughter, Alma, who was 6 months old when her father was abducted from their home in Kibbutz Nahal Oz, did not initially recognize him.

Since Hamas released the last 20 living Israeli hostages on Monday and the Israeli military began pulling back in the Gaza Strip, the former captives and their families are finally beginning a process of healing.

SEE HOSTAGES ON A13

Epstein-linked Prince Andrew gives up his Duke of York title

Move follows talks with king, publication of parts of accuser’s memoir

BY KARLA ADAM

LONDON — Prince Andrew has agreed to relinquish his Duke of York title after talks with his brother King Charles III — a stunning development following years of allegations linked to his association with Jeffrey Epstein that have cast a grim shadow over Britain’s royal family.

“In discussion with the king, and my immediate and wider family, we have concluded the continued accusations about me distract from the work of his majesty and the royal family,” Prince Andrew said in a state-

ment released Friday night by Buckingham Palace.

The decision comes after excerpts were made public from a forthcoming memoir by Virginia Giuffre — the American woman who says she was forced to have sexual encounters with Andrew as a teenager after being trafficked by Epstein, the financier and convicted sex offender who died in prison in 2019.

According to excerpts from the book that were published by the Guardian, Andrew told Giuffre that his daughters were “just a little younger than you” on the evening of their first alleged sexual encounter. She was 17 at the time.

“He was friendly enough,” Giuffre writes, “but still entitled — as if he believed having sex with me was his birthright.”

Andrew settled a civil lawsuit

SEE ANDREW ON A12

Trump floats a Ukraine armistice

FREEZE FIGHTING AT CURRENT POSITIONS

Zelensky is receptive; Putin likely a harder sell

BY MICHAEL BIRNBAUM
AND ISAAC ARNSDORF

President Donald Trump on Friday called for Russia and Ukraine to stop fighting at their current positions to settle the bitter war between the two nations — a proposal that Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said he accepted as a starting point for further talks.

The proposal was made during a West Wing meeting between the two leaders where Trump sought to replicate his success earlier this month in halting the fighting between Israel and Hamas. It was the latest effort by the U.S. president to cast himself as a global peacemaker, but his chances of success were far from clear as he gears up to meet with Russian President Vladimir Putin in coming weeks.

Putin has said in the past that he wants parts of Ukraine that his troops do not currently occupy as the price for peace. Trump, who spoke by phone to Putin on Thursday, said he had delivered the same message to both leaders.

“Enough blood has been shed, with property lines being defined by War and Guts,” Trump said on social media after Friday’s meeting. “They should stop where they are.”

Zelensky framed Trump’s proposal as a first step for broader negotiations and said the bigger question lay with Putin, whom he accused of not wanting peace.

“We have to stop where we are, he is right, the president is right,” Zelensky told reporters outside

SEE MEETING ON A10

Apex appearance: Looks matter to Trump, and he often says so. **A9**

Tomahawks: Missiles can reach Moscow, a possible tide-turner. **A10**

Trump’s tariffs bring India’s garment industry to its knees

Factories have ground to a halt, putting thousands out of work and upending lives, livelihoods

BY SUPRIYA KUMAR

TIRUPPUR, INDIA — If the tag on your T-shirt says “Made in India,” there’s a good chance it came from this southern industrial hub — long known as “Dollar City” for its dominance in the U.S. market.

Now, just seven weeks after the Trump administration imposed a 50 percent tariff on Indian exports, many of Tiruppur’s garment factories have ground to a halt. The slowdown has rippled through a vast network of hulking plants and small workshops, which employ more than 600,000 people. Thousands of fabric cutters, thread trimmers and sewing machine operators are suddenly out of work.

“Production has fallen by 25 percent across the board,” said G. Sampath, general secretary of the Center of Indian Trade Unions in Tiruppur. This city’s garment exports were valued at \$3.7 billion last year, according to the Tiruppur Exporters’ Association, and a third of the apparel manufactured here is normally shipped to American retailers, including

SEE INDIA ON A7



SUPRIYA KUMAR/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Manni, 66, and her daughter Illaikiya, 35, are now earning less than \$15 a week, down from \$34.

Files reveal doubts at FDA that device can protect brain

The Q-Collar is worn by NFL stars and youths. Does it really work?

BY WILL HOBSON
AND DANIEL GILBERT

One day this summer, Pat McAfee, the former NFL punter turned ESPN personality, interviewed New York Jets cornerback Sauce Gardner about his partnership with Q-Collar, the only medical device cleared by the FDA to address football’s brain injury crisis.

“We assumed it was bull—,” McAfee said. Until, that is, he visited the website of Q30 Innovations, the company behind the Q-Collar, which touts the device as “FDA-cleared and proven to help protect the brain.”

“The science is real,” McAfee said. “Hopefully this is something that helps the next generation.”

A C-shaped piece of springy metal coated in plastic that re-

tails for \$199, the Q-Collar is designed to apply pressure to the jugular veins, based on the theory that restricting the flow of blood from the skull limits how much the brain can jostle. “Like a seatbelt for your brain,” as Q30 puts it.

Since earning Food and Drug Administration clearance in 2021, Q30 has sold tens of thousands of Q-Collars to athletes as young as 13, and has gained supporters in Congress who are trying to steer the Defense Department to consider the device.

But internal FDA documents show that some of the agency’s reviewers doubted Q-Collar research showed the device offered meaningful protection against brain injury, damage or disease. The agency agreed to clear it, the records show, only after Q30 added language to its owner’s manual stating the device does not prevent concussions and that any claims it protects against long-term cognitive problems have “not been demonstrated.”

This language is nowhere to be found in Q30’s promotional ma-

SEE DEVICE ON A6

IN THE NEWS

Federal indictment Former national security adviser John Bolton pleaded not guilty to 18 counts of transmitting or retaining national defense information. **A4**

Pentagon press policy Just 15 people signed on to the new rules, according to an internal government document seen by The Post. **A12**

THE NATION Some Democrats worry that Maine Gov. Janet Mills, 77, is too old to run for the Senate. **A2**
ICE has been building out technology to monitor movements and social media activity. **A3**

THE WORLD Oxford Union’s president-elect faces removal after social media posts about Charlie Kirk. **A11**
The U.S. fell out of a top 10 list of the most powerful passports, the first time in decades. **A13**

THE ECONOMY Google ruled that Israel’s ads claiming “There is food in Gaza” aren’t misleading and don’t violate policy, an email revealed. **A14**
Recent fraud cases and bankruptcies raise concerns over unregulated loans, impacting U.S. banking stocks. **A14**

STYLE A new docuseries about cinema legend Martin Scorsese is as candid as it is reverential. **B1**

SPORTS Trinidad Chambliss, a transfer from D-II Ferris State, leads unbeaten Mississippi into a massive test at Georgia. **B7**

THE REGION Jay Jones (D) and Jason Miyares (R) square off in the only debate of race for Virginia attorney general. **B13**

OBITUARIES Ace Frehley, the hard-rocking Kiss guitarist who leaned into the group’s theatrics as a performer, was 74. **B15**

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